



Clothing as Evidence

Lab 8: FIVS 210

Grab your Camera! Make sure to charge your battery!

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Background

A clothing examination generally has three stages:

1. Observation of stains, deposits, and damage, including patterns and the general condition of the clothing. The data of the observations includes written and pictorial descriptions and measurements, where relevant.
2. Microscopic examination of stains, deposits, and damage, evaluation and comparison of patterns,
and preliminary chemical testing.
3. Sampling of selected stains and deposits for further testing



Photographing clothing evidence



Photographs are an especially useful tool for an examiner's notes and are quick and easy to take now using current digital cameras.

- Overall shots of the front and back of the garment should be taken.
- Close -ups can be taken of various pertinent areas once recognized.
- Again, scales should be included in any photograph.
- Such photographs do not substitute for a good diagram and vice versa, as both emphasize different information



Notes to Take

General description of items:

- Type of garment and where worn on the body (if worn)
- Color, size, brand, style, etc.
- Clothing received inside out, buttoned up, etc.
- General description of fabric or other material (e.g., knit, blue jean denim)
- Types of closures (buttons, zippers, Velcro, etc.—open or closed?)
- General condition (e.g., “clothing fairly clean with few deposits, minor body odor”), whether well-worn, or apparently new, dry, damp, or wet)



Today's Lab

1. Be sure to wear the proper PPE (wear gloves).

2. Place an article of clothing, provided to you, on a table (or the floor if easier), laying a piece of Kraft paper down first.

3. Document its appearance by photographing both the front and back of the garment.

4. If the garment fits into a lighting tent (Studio in a Box), then that can be used as well, or any other type of accessory lighting, if available.

5. Be sure to document any defects (cuts, tears, bullet holes, etc.) with a close-up photograph, containing an appropriate scale.

6. Document any labels attached to the garment, which may include the size, make, and fabric composition

7. Take notes, photographs, and make sketches (if necessary)



- Notes and diagram at the back of photolog or electronically

PHOTOGRAPHY LOG

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- no matter how many pages it takes label it!!

Focal length

shown in camera

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Agency Name Sunshine Forensics		Incident# FIVS 210-1234					
Date 02-19-2025		Photographer Shaifer Goolen					
Location HEEP 205, 370 Olsen Drive					Town/Village/City College Station, TX 77843		
Incident Type: Death Investigation		Camera Type: ☐ Film ☒ Digital		Filter: ☐ No ☒ Yes			
Film Type: ☒ Digital		Film Speed: _____		Roll# _____			
Exposure Number	Description	ISO	<u>Lens</u>	Flash	F/Stop	Shutter	Remarks
0001	Scene identifier	1600	55	Ext.	F/11	1/100	Dark
0002	Overall	3200	18	B.in	F/22	1/60	Bright
0003	Mid-range	400	35	Diff.	F/16	1/250	_____
0004	Close-UP	800	55	Bounce	F/4.0	1/15	Bright

means it was perfect "no comment"

Now specify what kind of Flash

Front



Back



- T-shirt
- Worn on torso
- Maroon, XL, Gildan, T-shirt
- Received right side out
- Cotton
- Closed
- Clothing well-worn with multiple holes and a couple stains

□ - Stain

▨ - Hole